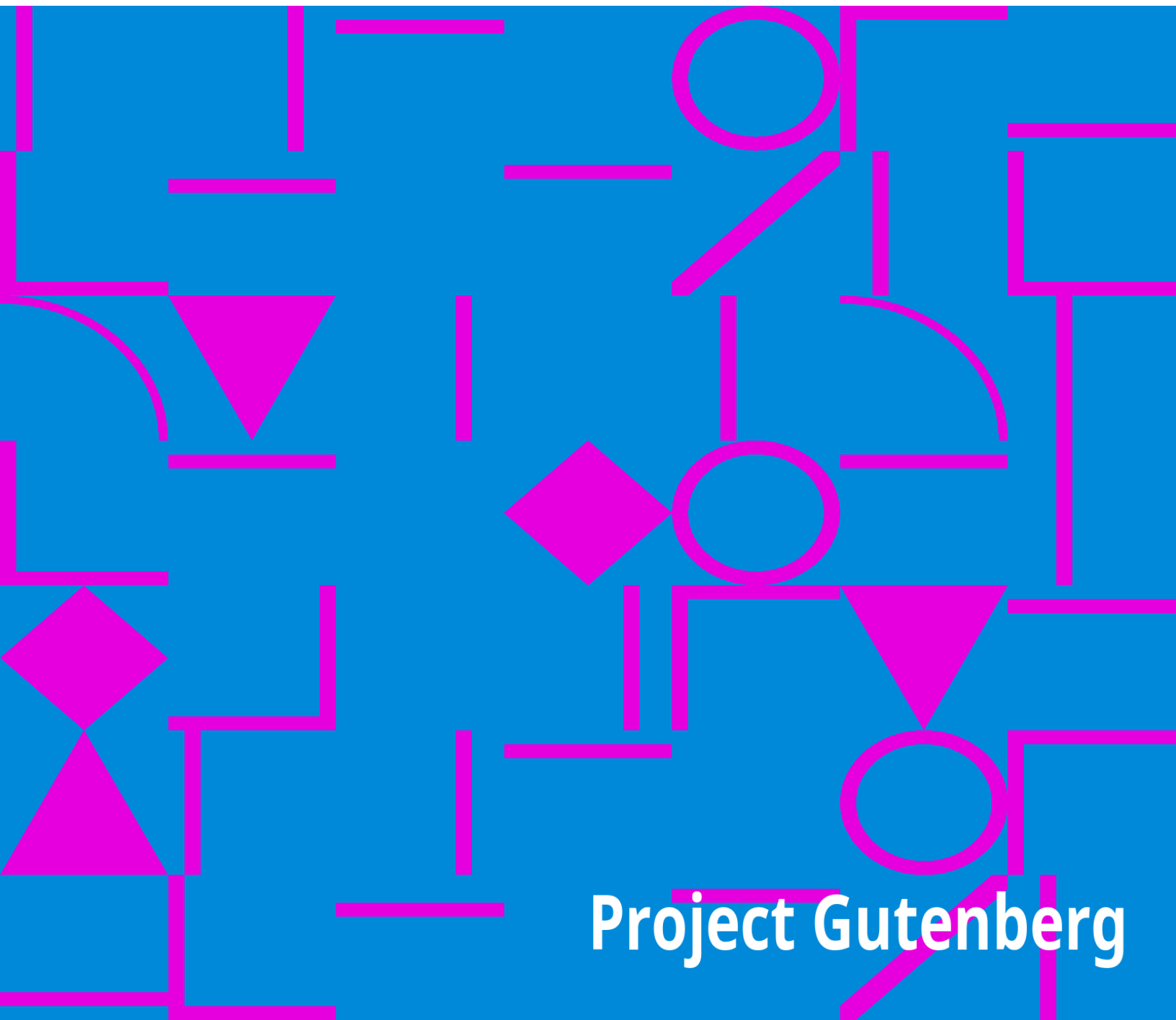


The World English Bible (WEB): Hosea

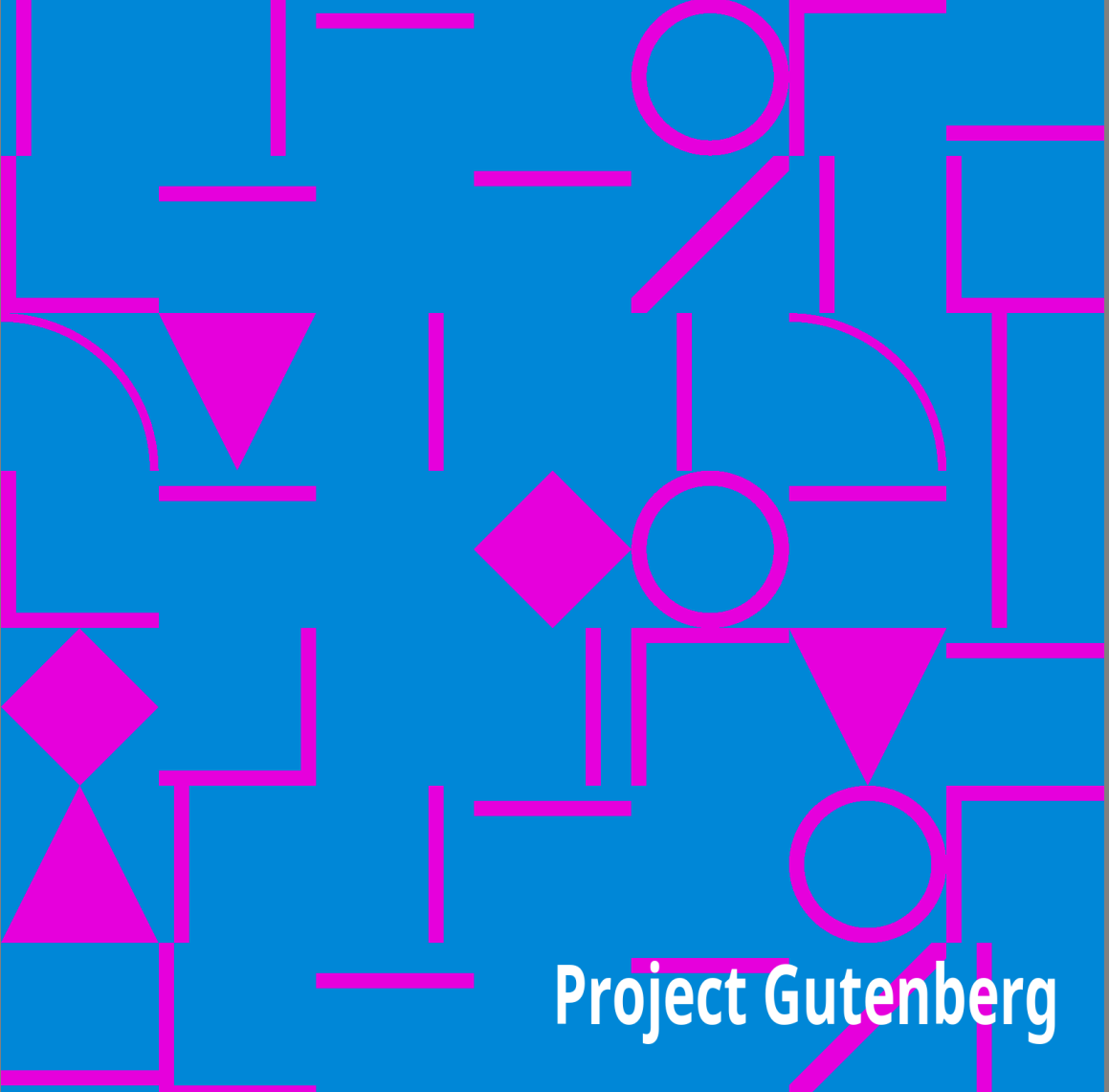
Anonymous

The background of the lower half of the image is a solid blue color. Overlaid on this background is a complex, abstract pattern of magenta (bright pink) geometric shapes. These shapes include circles, triangles, diamonds, and various straight lines of different lengths and orientations. Some shapes are solid magenta, while others are outlined in magenta. The pattern is dense and non-repeating, creating a modern, geometric aesthetic.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE WORLD
ENGLISH BIBLE (WEB): HOSEA ***

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Book 28 Hosea 001:001 The word of Yahweh that came to Hosea the son of Beerī, in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash, king of Israel. 001:002 When Yahweh spoke at the first by Hosea, Yahweh said to Hosea, "Go, take for yourself a wife of prostitution and children of unfaithfulness; for the land commits great adultery,

forsaking Yahweh." 001:003 So he went and took Gomer the daughter of Diblaim; and she conceived, and bore him a son. 001:004 Yahweh said to him, "Call his name Jezreel; for yet a little while, and I will avenge the blood of Jezreel on the house of Jehu, and will cause the kingdom of the house of Israel to cease. 001:005 It will happen in that day that I will break the bow of Israel in the valley of Jezreel." 001:006 She conceived again, and bore a daughter. Then he said to him, "Call her name Lo-Ruhamah{Lo-Ruhamah means "not loved."}; for I will no longer have mercy on the house of Israel,

that I should in any way pardon them. 001:007 But I will have mercy on the house of Judah, and will save them by Yahweh their God, and will not save them by bow, sword, battle, horses, or horsemen." 001:008 Now when she had weaned Lo-Ruhamah, she conceived, and bore a son. 001:009 He said, "Call his name Lo-Ammi{Lo-Ammi means "not my people"}; for you are not my people, and I will not be yours. 001:010 Yet the number of the children of Israel will be as the sand of the sea, which can't be measured nor numbered; and it will come to pass that, in the place

where it was said to them, 'You are not my people,' they will be called 'sons of the living God.' 001:011

The children of Judah and the children of Israel will be gathered together, and they will appoint themselves one head, and will go up from the land; for great will be the day of Jezreel. 002:001 "Say to

your brothers, 'My people!'{'Ammi' in Hebrew} and to your sisters, 'My loved one!'{'Ruhamah' in Hebrew}

002:002 Contend with your mother! Contend, for she is not my wife, neither am I her husband; and let her put away her prostitution from her face, and her

**adulteries from between her
breasts; 002:003 Lest I strip her
naked, and make her bare as in the
day that she was born, and make
her like a wilderness, and set her
like a dry land, and kill her with
thirst. 002:004 Indeed, on her
children I will have no mercy; for
they are children of unfaithfulness;
002:005 For their mother has
played the prostitute. She who
conceived them has done
shamefully; for she said, 'I will go
after my lovers, who give me my
bread and my water, my wool and
my flax, my oil and my drink.'
002:006 Therefore, behold, I will
hedge up your way with thorns,**

**and I will build a wall against her,
that she can't find her way. 002:007
She will follow after her lovers, but
she won't overtake them; and she
will seek them, but won't find
them. Then she will say, 'I will go
and return to my first husband; for
then was it better with me than
now.' 002:008 For she did not know
that I gave her the grain, the new
wine, and the oil, and multiplied to
her silver and gold, which they
used for Baal. 002:009 Therefore I
will take back my grain in its time,
and my new wine in its season, and
will pluck away my wool and my
flax which should have covered her
nakedness. 002:010 Now I will**

uncover her lewdness in the sight of her lovers, and no one will deliver her out of my hand. 002:011 I will also cause all her celebrations to cease: her feasts, her new moons, her Sabbaths, and all her solemn assemblies. 002:012 I will lay waste her vines and her fig trees, about which she has said, 'These are my wages that my lovers have given me; and I will make them a forest,' and the animals of the field shall eat them. 002:013 I will visit on her the days of the Baals, to which she burned incense, when she decked herself with her earrings and her jewels, and went after her lovers, and forgot me," says Yahweh.

002:014 "Therefore, behold, I will allure her, and bring her into the wilderness, and speak tenderly to her. 002:015 I will give her vineyards from there, and the valley of Achor for a door of hope; and she will respond there, as in the days of her youth, and as in the day when she came up out of the land of Egypt. 002:016 It will be in that day," says Yahweh, "that you will call me 'my husband,' and no longer call me 'my master.' 002:017 For I will take away the names of the Baals out of her mouth, and they will no longer be mentioned by name. 002:018 In that day I will make a covenant for them with the

**animals of the field, and with the
birds of the sky, and with the
creeping things of the ground. I will
break the bow, the sword, and the
battle out of the land, and will
make them lie down safely. 002:019
I will betroth you to me forever.
Yes, I will betroth you to me in
righteousness, in justice, in loving
kindness, and in compassion.
002:020 I will even betroth you to
me in faithfulness; and you shall
know Yahweh. 002:021 It will
happen in that day, I will respond,"
says Yahweh, "I will respond to the
heavens, and they will respond to
the earth; 002:022 and the earth
will respond to the grain, and the**

new wine, and the oil; and they will respond to Jezreel. 002:023 I will sow her to me in the earth; and I will have mercy on her who had not obtained mercy; and I will tell those who were not my people, 'You are my people;' and they will say, 'My God!'" 003:001 Yahweh said to me, "Go again, love a woman loved by another, and an adulteress, even as Yahweh loves the children of Israel, though they turn to other gods, and love cakes of raisins." 003:002 So I bought her for myself for fifteen pieces of silver and a homer and a half of barley. 003:003 I said to her, "You shall stay with me many days. You shall not play

the prostitute, and you shall not be with any other man. I will also be so toward you." 003:004 For the children of Israel shall abide many days without king, and without prince, and without sacrifice, and without sacred stone, and without ephod or idols. 003:005 Afterward the children of Israel shall return, and seek Yahweh their God, and David their king, and shall come with trembling to Yahweh and to his blessings in the last days.

004:001 Hear the word of Yahweh, you children of Israel; for Yahweh has a charge against the inhabitants of the land: "Indeed there is no truth, nor goodness, nor

knowledge of God in the land.

004:002 There is cursing, lying, murder, stealing, and committing adultery; they break boundaries, and bloodshed causes bloodshed.

004:003 Therefore the land will mourn, and everyone who dwells therein will waste away. all living things in her, even the animals of the field and the birds of the sky; yes, the fish of the sea also die.

004:004 "Yet let no man bring a charge, neither let any man accuse; For your people are like those who bring charges against a priest.

004:005 You will stumble in the day, and the prophet will also stumble with you in the night; and

**I will destroy your mother. 004:006
My people are destroyed for lack of
knowledge. Because you have
rejected knowledge, I will also
reject you, that you may be no
priest to me. Because you have
forgotten your God's law, I will also
forget your children. 004:007 As
they were multiplied, so they sinned
against me. I will change their
glory into shame. 004:008 They
feed on the sin of my people, and
set their heart on their iniquity.
004:009 It will be, like people, like
priest; and I will punish them for
their ways, and will repay them for
their deeds. 004:010 They will eat,
and not have enough. They will**

play the prostitute, and will not increase; because they have abandoned giving to Yahweh.

004:011 Prostitution, wine, and new wine take away understanding.

004:012 My people consult with their wooden idol, and answer to a stick of wood. Indeed the spirit of prostitution has led them astray, and they have been unfaithful to their God. 004:013 They sacrifice on the tops of the mountains, and burn incense on the hills, under oaks and poplars and terebinths, because its shade is good. Therefore your daughters play the prostitute, and your brides commit adultery.

004:014 I will not punish your

daughters when they play the prostitute, nor your brides when they commit adultery; because the men consort with prostitutes, and they sacrifice with the shrine prostitutes; so the people without understanding will come to ruin.

004:015 "Though you, Israel, play the prostitute, yet don't let Judah offend; and don't come to Gilgal, neither go up to Beth Aven, nor swear, 'As Yahweh lives.' 004:016

For Israel has behaved extremely stubbornly, like a stubborn heifer.

Then how will Yahweh feed them like a lamb in a meadow. 004:017

Ephraim is joined to idols. Leave him alone! 004:018 Their drink has

become sour. They play the prostitute continually. Her rulers dearly love their shameful way.

004:019 The wind has wrapped her up in its wings; and they shall be disappointed because of their

sacrifices. 005:001 "Listen to this, you priests! Listen, house of Israel, and give ear, house of the king! For the judgment is against you; for you have been a snare at Mizpah, and a net spread on Tabor. 005:002

The rebels are deep in slaughter; but I discipline all of them. 005:003

I know Ephraim, and Israel is not hidden from me; for now, Ephraim, you have played the prostitute.

Israel is defiled. 005:004 Their

**deeds won't allow them to turn to
their God; for the spirit of
prostitution is within them, and
they don't know Yahweh. 005:005
The pride of Israel testifies to his
face. Therefore Israel and Ephraim
will stumble in their iniquity. Judah
also will stumble with them.
005:006 They will go with their
flocks and with their herds to seek
Yahweh; but they won't find him.
He has withdrawn himself from
them. 005:007 They are unfaithful
to Yahweh; for they have borne
illegitimate children. Now the new
moon will devour them with their
fields. 005:008 "Blow the cornet in
Gibeah, and the trumpet in**

Ramah! Sound a battle cry at Beth Aven, behind you, Benjamin!

005:009 Ephraim will become a desolation in the day of rebuke.

Among the tribes of Israel, I have made known that which will surely be. 005:010 The princes of Judah are like those who remove a landmark. I will pour out my wrath on them like water. 005:011

Ephraim is oppressed, he is crushed in judgment; Because he is intent in his pursuit of idols.

005:012 Therefore I am to Ephraim like a moth, and to the house of Judah like rottenness. 005:013

"When Ephraim saw his sickness, and Judah his wound, Then

Ephraim went to Assyria, and sent to king Jareb: but he is not able to heal you, neither will he cure you of your wound. 005:014 For I will be to Ephraim like a lion, and like a young lion to the house of Judah. I myself will tear in pieces and go away. I will carry off, and there will be no one to deliver. 005:015 I will go and return to my place, until they acknowledge their offense, and seek my face. In their affliction they will seek me earnestly."

006:001 "Come, and let us return to Yahweh; for he has torn us to pieces, and he will heal us; he has injured us, and he will bind up our wounds. 006:002 After two days he

**will revive us. On the third day he
will raise us up, and we will live
before him. 006:003 Let us
acknowledge Yahweh. Let us press
on to know Yahweh. As surely as
the sun rises, Yahweh will appear.
He will come to us like the rain, like
the spring rain that waters the
earth." 006:004 "Ephraim, what
shall I do to you? Judah, what shall
I do to you? For your love is like a
morning cloud, and like the dew
that disappears early. 006:005
Therefore I have cut them to pieces
with the prophets; I killed them
with the words of my mouth. Your
judgments are like a flash of
lightning. 006:006 For I desire**

mercy, and not sacrifice; and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings. 006:007 But they, like Adam, have broken the covenant. They were unfaithful to me, there. 006:008 Gilead is a city of those who work iniquity; it is stained with blood. 006:009 As gangs of robbers wait to ambush a man, so the company of priests murder in the way toward Shechem, committing shameful crimes. 006:010 In the house of Israel I have seen a horrible thing. There is prostitution in Ephraim. Israel is defiled. 006:011 "Also, Judah, there is a harvest appointed for you, when I restore the fortunes of my

people. 007:001 When I would heal Israel, then the iniquity of Ephraim is uncovered, also the wickedness of Samaria; for they commit falsehood, and the thief enters in, and the gang of robbers ravages outside. 007:002 They don't consider in their hearts that I remember all their wickedness. Now their own deeds have engulfed them. They are before my face. 007:003 They make the king glad with their wickedness, and the princes with their lies. 007:004 They are all adulterers. They are burning like an oven that the baker stops stirring, from the kneading of the dough, until it is leavened.

**007:005 On the day of our king, the
princes made themselves sick with
the heat of wine. He joined his
hand with mockers. 007:006 For
they have made ready their heart
like an oven, while they lie in wait.
Their baker sleeps all the night. In
the morning it burns as a flaming
fire. 007:007 They are all hot as an
oven, and devour their judges. All
their kings have fallen. There is no
one among them who calls to me.
007:008 Ephraim, he mixes himself
among the nations. Ephraim is a
pancake not turned over. 007:009
Strangers have devoured his
strength, and he doesn't realize it.
Indeed, gray hairs are here and**

**there on him, and he doesn't realize
it. 007:010 The pride of Israel
testifies to his face; yet they haven't
returned to Yahweh their God, nor
sought him, for all this. 007:011**

**"Ephraim is like an easily deceived
dove, without understanding. They
call to Egypt. They go to Assyria.**

**007:012 When they go, I will
spread my net on them. I will bring
them down like the birds of the sky.
I will chastise them, as their
congregation has heard. 007:013**

**Woe to them! For they have
wandered from me. Destruction to
them! For they have trespassed
against me. Though I would
redeem them, yet they have spoken**

lies against me. 007:014 They haven't cried to me with their heart, but they howl on their beds. They assemble themselves for grain and new wine. They turn away from me. 007:015 Though I have taught and strengthened their arms, yet they plot evil against me. 007:016 They return, but not to the Most High. They are like a faulty bow. Their princes will fall by the sword for the rage of their tongue. This will be their derision in the land of Egypt. 008:001 "Put the trumpet to your lips! Something like an eagle is over Yahweh's house, because they have broken my covenant, and rebelled against

**my law. 008:002 They cry to me,
'My God, we Israel acknowledge
you!' 008:003 Israel has cast off
that which is good. The enemy will
pursue him. 008:004 They have set
up kings, but not by me. They have
made princes, and I didn't approve.
Of their silver and their gold they
have made themselves idols, that
they may be cut off. 008:005 Let
Samaria throw out his calf idol! My
anger burns against them! How
long will it be until they are capable
of purity? 008:006 For this is even
from Israel! The workman made it,
and it is no God; indeed, the calf of
Samaria shall be broken in pieces.
008:007 For they sow the wind, and**

they will reap the whirlwind. He has no standing grain. The stalk will yield no head. If it does yield, strangers will swallow it up.

008:008 Israel is swallowed up.

Now they are among the nations like a worthless thing. 008:009 For they have gone up to Assyria, like a wild donkey wandering alone.

Ephraim has hired lovers for himself. 008:010 But although they sold themselves among the nations, I will now gather them; and they begin to waste away because of the oppression of the king of mighty ones. 008:011 Because Ephraim has multiplied altars for sinning, they became for him altars for sinning.

008:012 I wrote for him the many things of my law; but they were regarded as a strange thing.

008:013 As for the sacrifices of my offerings, they sacrifice flesh and eat it; But Yahweh doesn't accept them. Now he will remember their iniquity, and punish their sins.

They will return to Egypt. 008:014 For Israel has forgotten his Maker and built palaces; and Judah has multiplied fortified cities; but I will send a fire on his cities, and it will devour its fortresses." 009:001

Don't rejoice, Israel, to jubilation like the nations; for you were unfaithful to your God. You love the wages of a prostitute at every

grain threshing floor. 009:002 The threshing floor and the winepress won't feed them, and the new wine will fail her. 009:003 They won't dwell in Yahweh's land; but Ephraim will return to Egypt, and they will eat unclean food in Assyria. 009:004 They won't pour out wine offerings to Yahweh, neither will they be pleasing to him. Their sacrifices will be to them like the bread of mourners; all who eat of it will be polluted; for their bread will be for their appetite. It will not come into the house of Yahweh. 009:005 What will you do in the day of solemn assembly, and in the day of the feast of Yahweh?

009:006 For, behold, they have gone away from destruction. Egypt will gather them up. Memphis will bury them. Nettles will possess their pleasant things of silver.

Thorns will be in their tents.

009:007 The days of visitation have come. The days of reckoning have come. Israel will consider the prophet to be a fool, and the man who is inspired to be insane, because of the abundance of your sins, and because your hostility is great. 009:008 A prophet watches

over Ephraim with my God. A fowler's snare is on all of his paths, and hostility in the house of his God. 009:009 They have deeply

corrupted themselves, as in the days of Gibeah. He will remember their iniquity. He will punish them for their sins. 009:010 I found Israel like grapes in the wilderness. I saw your fathers as the first ripe in the fig tree at its first season; but they came to Baal Peor, and consecrated themselves to the shameful thing, and became abominable like that which they loved. 009:011 As for Ephraim, their glory will fly away like a bird. There will be no birth, none with child, and no conception. 009:012 Though they bring up their children, yet I will bereave them, so that not a man shall be left. Indeed,

**woe also to them when I depart
from them! 009:013 I have seen
Ephraim, like Tyre, planted in a
pleasant place; but Ephraim will
bring out his children to the
murderer. 009:014 Give them—
Yahweh what will you give? Give
them a miscarrying womb and dry
breasts. 009:015 "All their
wickedness is in Gilgal; for there I
hated them. Because of the
wickedness of their deeds I will
drive them out of my house! I will
love them no more. All their princes
are rebels. 009:016 Ephraim is
struck. Their root has dried up.
They will bear no fruit. Even
though they bring forth, yet I will**

**kill the beloved ones of their
womb." 009:017 My God will cast
them away, because they did not
listen to him; and they will be
wanderers among the nations.**

**010:001 Israel is a luxuriant vine
that puts forth his fruit. According
to the abundance of his fruit he has
multiplied his altars. As their land
has prospered, they have adorned
their sacred stones. 010:002 Their
heart is divided. Now they will be
found guilty. He will demolish their
altars. He will destroy their sacred
stones. 010:003 Surely now they
will say, "We have no king; for we
don't fear Yahweh; and the king,
what can he do for us?" 010:004**

**They make promises, swearing
falsely in making covenants.**

**Therefore judgment springs up like
poisonous weeds in the furrows of
the field. 010:005 The inhabitants
of Samaria will be in terror for the
calves of Beth Aven; for its people
will mourn over it, Along with its
priests who rejoiced over it, for its
glory, because it has departed from
it. 010:006 It also will be carried to
Assyria for a present to a great
king. Ephraim will receive shame,
and Israel will be ashamed of his
own counsel. 010:007 Samaria and
her king float away, like a twig on
the water. 010:008 The high places
also of Aven, the sin of Israel, will**

**be destroyed. The thorn and the
thistle will come up on their altars.
They will tell the mountains,
"Cover us!" and the hills, "Fall on
us!" 010:009 "Israel, you have
sinned from the days of Gibeah.
There they remained. The battle
against the children of iniquity
doesn't overtake them in Gibeah.
010:010 When it is my desire, I will
chastise them; and the nations will
be gathered against them, when
they are bound to their two
transgressions. 010:011 Ephraim is
a trained heifer that loves to
thresh; so I will put a yoke on her
beautiful neck. I will set a rider on
Ephraim. Judah will plow. Jacob**

will break his clods. 010:012 Sow to yourselves in righteousness, reap according to kindness. Break up your fallow ground; for it is time to seek Yahweh, until he comes and rains righteousness on you. 010:013 You have plowed wickedness. You have reaped iniquity. You have eaten the fruit of lies, for you trusted in your way, in the multitude of your mighty men. 010:014 Therefore a battle roar will arise among your people, and all your fortresses will be destroyed, as Shalman destroyed Beth Arbel in the day of battle. The mother was dashed in pieces with her children. 010:015 So Bethel will do to you

**because of your great wickedness.
At daybreak the king of Israel will
be destroyed. 011:001 "When Israel
was a child, then I loved him, and
called my son out of Egypt. 011:002
They called to them, so they went
from them. They sacrificed to the
Baals, and burned incense to
engraved images. 011:003 Yet I
taught Ephraim to walk. I took
them by his arms; but they didn't
know that I healed them. 011:004 I
drew them with cords of a man,
with ties of love; and I was to them
like those who lift up the yoke on
their necks; and I bent down to him
and I fed him. 011:005 "They won't
return into the land of Egypt; but**

**the Assyrian will be their king,
because they refused to repent.
011:006 The sword will fall on their
cities, and will destroy the bars of
their gates, and will put an end to
their plans. 011:007 My people are
determined to turn from me.
Though they call to the Most High,
he certainly won't exalt them.
011:008 "How can I give you up,
Ephraim? How can I hand you
over, Israel? How can I make you
like Admah? How can I make you
like Zeboiim? My heart is turned
within me, my compassion is
aroused. 011:009 I will not execute
the fierceness of my anger. I will
not return to destroy Ephraim: for**

I am God, and not man; the Holy One in the midst of you; and I will not come in wrath. 011:010 They will walk after Yahweh, who will roar like a lion; for he will roar, and the children will come trembling from the west. 011:011 They will come trembling like a bird out of Egypt, and like a dove out of the land of Assyria; and I will settle them in their houses," says Yahweh. 011:012 Ephraim surrounds me with falsehood, and the house of Israel with deceit. Judah still strays from God, and is unfaithful to the Holy One. 012:001 Ephraim feeds on wind, and chases the east wind. He continually

**multiplies lies and desolation. They
make a covenant with Assyria, and
oil is carried into Egypt. 012:002**

**Yahweh also has a controversy with
Judah, and will punish Jacob
according to his ways; according to
his deeds he will repay him.**

**012:003 In the womb he took his
brother by the heel; and in his
manhood he contended with God.**

**012:004 Indeed, he struggled with
the angel, and prevailed; he wept,
and made supplication to him. He
found him at Bethel, and there he
spoke with us, 012:005 even**

**Yahweh, the God of Armies;
Yahweh is his name of renown!**

012:006 Therefore turn to your

**God. Keep kindness and justice,
and wait continually for your God.
012:007 A merchant has dishonest
scales in his hand. He loves to
defraud. 012:008 Ephraim said,
"Surely I have become rich, I have
found myself wealth. In all my
wealth they won't find in me any
iniquity that is sin." 012:009 "But I
am Yahweh your God from the
land of Egypt. I will yet again make
you dwell in tents, as in the days of
the solemn feast. 012:010 I have
also spoken to the prophets, and I
have multiplied visions; and by the
ministry of the prophets I have
used parables. 012:011 If Gilead is
wicked, surely they are worthless.**

**In Gilgal they sacrifice bulls.
Indeed, their altars are like heaps
in the furrows of the field. 012:012
Jacob fled into the country of
Aram, and Israel served to get a
wife, and for a wife he tended
flocks and herds. 012:013 By a
prophet Yahweh brought Israel up
out of Egypt, and by a prophet he
was preserved. 012:014 Ephraim
has bitterly provoked anger.
Therefore his blood will be left on
him, and his Lord will repay his
contempt. 013:001 When Ephraim
spoke, there was trembling. He
exalted himself in Israel, but when
he became guilty in Baal, he died.
013:002 Now they sin more and**

**more, and have made themselves
molten images of their silver, even
idols according to their own
understanding, all of them the
work of the craftsmen. They say of
them, 'They offer human sacrifice
and kiss the calves.' 013:003**

**Therefore they will be like the
morning mist, and like the dew that
passes away early, like the chaff
that is driven with the whirlwind
out of the threshing floor, and like
the smoke out of the chimney.**

**013:004 "Yet I am Yahweh your
God from the land of Egypt; and
you shall acknowledge no god but
me, and besides me there is no
savior. 013:005 I knew you in the**

wilderness, in the land of great drought. 013:006 According to their pasture, so were they filled; they were filled, and their heart was exalted. Therefore they have forgotten me. 013:007 Therefore I am like a lion to them. Like a leopard, I will lurk by the path. 013:008 I will meet them like a bear that is bereaved of her cubs, and will tear the covering of their heart. There I will devour them like a lioness. The wild animal will tear them. 013:009 You are destroyed, Israel, because you are against me, against your help. 013:010 Where is your king now, that he may save you in all your cities? And your

**judges, of whom you said, 'Give me
a king and princes?' 013:011 I have
given you a king in my anger, and
have taken him away in my wrath.**

**013:012 The guilt of Ephraim is
stored up. His sin is stored up.**

**013:013 The sorrows of a travailing
woman will come on him. He is an
unwise son; for when it is time, he
doesn't come to the opening of the
womb. 013:014 I will ransom them
from the power of Sheol. I will
redeem them from death! Death,
where are your plagues? Sheol,
where is your destruction?**

**"Compassion will be hidden from
my eyes. 013:015 Though he is
fruitful among his brothers, an east**

**wind will come, the breath of
Yahweh coming up from the
wilderness; and his spring will
become dry, and his fountain will
be dried up. He will plunder the
storehouse of treasure. 013:016**

**Samaria will bear her guilt; for she
has rebelled against her God. They
will fall by the sword. Their infants
will be dashed in pieces, and their
pregnant women will be ripped
open." 014:001 Israel, return to
Yahweh your God; for you have
fallen because of your sin. 014:002
Take words with you, and return to
Yahweh. Tell him, "Forgive all our
sins, and accept that which is good:
so we offer our lips like bulls.**

014:003 Assyria can't save us. We won't ride on horses; neither will we say any more to the work of our hands, 'Our gods!' for in you the fatherless finds mercy." 014:004 "I will heal their waywardness. I will love them freely; for my anger is turned away from him. 014:005 I will be like the dew to Israel. He will blossom like the lily, and send down his roots like Lebanon. 014:006 His branches will spread, and his beauty will be like the olive tree, and his fragrance like Lebanon. 014:007 Men will dwell in his shade. They will revive like the grain, and blossom like the vine. Their fragrance will be like the

wine of Lebanon. 014:008

Ephraim, what have I to do any more with idols? I answer, and will take care of him. I am like a green fir tree; from me your fruit is found." 014:009 Who is wise, that he may understand these things? Who is prudent, that he may know them? For the ways of Yahweh are right, and the righteous walk in them; But the rebellious stumble in them.

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